

PROPHETS AND PROPHECY – PATHFINDER HONOR NOTES

1. Definition of a Prophet and Their Role in God's Church

A prophet is a person chosen by God to speak on His behalf. Prophets communicate God's messages through spoken words, written messages, visions, dreams, and symbolic actions. Their role is not only to predict future events but mainly to call God's people to repentance, obedience, and faithfulness.

Role in God's Church:

Reveal God's will (Amos 3:7)

Call people to repentance (Jeremiah 25:4–5)

Provide guidance and correction

Encourage faith and hope

Prepare people for future events

2. Four Major and Twelve Minor Prophets (Old Testament)

Major Prophets:

1. Isaiah

2. Jeremiah

3. Ezekiel

4. Daniel

Minor Prophets:

1. Hosea

2. Joel

3. Amos

4. Obadiah

5. Jonah

6. Micah

7. Nahum

8. Habakkuk

9. Zephaniah

10. Haggai

11. Zechariah

12. Malachi

3. Difference Between Major and Minor Prophets

The difference is not importance, but length of writings.

Major Prophets wrote longer books.

Minor Prophets wrote shorter books.

4. Two New Testament Prophets and Their Roles

John the Baptist – Prepared the way for Jesus (Matthew 3:1–3)

John the Revelator – Received visions recorded in Revelation to guide the end-time church

5. Female Prophets in the Old Testament

Miriam – Leader and worship prophetess (Exodus 15:20)

Deborah – Judge and prophetess of Israel (Judges 4:4)

Huldah – Gave counsel during King Josiah's reign (2 Kings 22:14)

6. Definition of Prophecy and Its Role in God's Church

Prophecy is the communication of God's message to humanity. It may include warnings, encouragement, instruction, or future events.

Role:

Strengthens faith

Confirms God's control of history

Points people to salvation through Jesus

7. Prophecy and the Testimony of Jesus

Revelation 14:12 – God’s people keep His commandments and have faith in Jesus

Revelation 19:10 – “The testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy”

Prophecy always points to Jesus Christ as Savior and Lord.

8. Tests of a True Prophet

(Based on Deuteronomy 18:22; 1 John 4:1–3; Jeremiah 23:18–32)

Messages agree with Scripture

Prophecies are fulfilled

Confesses Jesus Christ

Produces good spiritual fruit

Leads people to God, not self

9. Prophecy Given to Non-Prophets

Pharaoh (Genesis 41)

Nebuchadnezzar (Daniel 2 & 4)

Balaam (Numbers 22–24)

God may give prophecy to anyone, but interpretation comes from Him.

10. Character Studies

- a. Joseph – Faithful interpreter of dreams
- b. Jonah – Reluctant prophet to Nineveh
- c. Balaam – Used by God despite disobedience
- d. Daniel – Interpreter of royal dreams
- e. John – Vision of the new earth (Revelation 21)

11. Dual Prophecy – Matthew 24

Jesus' prophecy applies to:

Fall of Jerusalem (AD 70)

End-time events

Many signs have both immediate and future fulfillment.

12. Symbols in Biblical Prophecy

Beasts – Kingdoms or nations (Daniel 7)

Water – Peoples and nations (Revelation 17:15)

Horns – Kings or powers (Daniel 8)

13. Nebuchadnezzar's Dream – Daniel 2

Head of Gold – Babylon

Chest of Silver – Medo-Persia

Belly of Brass – Greece

Legs of Iron – Rome

Feet of Iron & Clay – Divided kingdoms

Stone – God's eternal kingdom

14. Role of Prophets in Strengthening the Church

Provide spiritual direction

Call for reform

Protect the church from deception

Prepare God's people for Christ's return

Conclusion

Prophets and prophecy are gifts from God to guide, protect, and prepare His people. Through them, God reveals His love, His warnings, and His plan of salvation centered on Jesus Christ.